

ANIME

Tate no Yuusha no Nariagari

Yet another Isekai anime, but one that brings something different to the table

★★★★☆ | The isekai format, popularised by Sword Art Online, has been done to death in the anime industry. In case you're wondering, the isekai format is basically a situation where the main character, or the setting of the anime, is transported to an alternate world or dimension. The main characters are usually shut-in gamers in the real world who suck at real life, but in this alternative world, they're the authority thanks to the long hours spent playing video games.

Tate no Yuusha no Nariagari (The Rising of the Shield Hero) starts off as a generic isekai anime, but by the end of the hour-long first episode, you realise that it also brings something unique to the table. For a brief idea, the shield hero is summoned to a country where he isn't wanted, he's mistreated, framed for a crime, and robbed of everything. The shield hero is left with nothing but the desire to take revenge on the country and its people. The show is still airing as of writing this review. But of whatever we've watched until this point, they've paced things a little too fast. It's still a good watch, and easily among the better anime this season.



MOVIE

The Wandering Earth

A conceptually stunning sci-fi movie from China

★★★★☆ | This movie seems like a big budget Hollywood sci-fi movie, but happens to be produced in China. Humanity is facing a crisis. The Sun is getting super active threatening every life form on the planet. The Sun is in the process of going nova, and scientists realise that the star will expand to beyond the orbit of the Earth. Humanity builds massive engines that convert the planet into a spaceship, which starts its journey to the Alpha Centauri system, a red dwarf star that has a longer life span than the Sun. Most of humanity moves to underground hive cities, while the surface freezes over. To begin the interstellar journey, Earth has to execute an orbital assist maneuver. It is during this phase when things go horribly wrong.

Everything you expect from a sci-fi movie is present, including massive engineering projects, rocket engines and futuristic soldiers. There are many homages to 2001: A Space Odyssey. The zero gravity camerawork is top notch. The movie manages to be a joyride that keeps you on tenterhooks throughout. Unfortunately, the story does not track its base material, an excellent novella written by award winning Chinese science fiction author, Liu Cixin.



UP AND COMING

MOVIE

MIB International



The cast of Ragnarok, sans the Hulk, return as Agent H and Agent M in Men in Black International. Except, one of them is a

woman now. We're curious to see how MIB feels without both Agent J and Agent K.

Release date: June 14th, 2019

MOVIE

Toy Story 4



Kind of like the wait for the Incredibles 2, Toy Story 4 is another sequel we've been waiting for a long time. 9 years to be

exact. This time around, it appears the Toys are going through an existential crisis of sorts.

Release date: June 21st, 2019

MOVIE

Dark Phoenix



The Dark Phoenix is the most powerful foe the X-Men have faced yet. What makes things more difficult is that it's

one of their own, Jean Grey. Also, there's aliens who are coming to Earth for her powers now. Fun times.

Release date: June 7th, 2019